

Ben Walker

/ Software Engineer

📍 Portland, OR

A hard-working, analytical computer scientist with over a decade of experience who values leadership, ingenuity, diligence, and education. The best things in life are great documentation, easy-to-use software, and easy-to-work-with people.

Experience

Senior Backend Software Engineer (Access Control)

Webflow, July 2024 - Present

Collaborating across the org to introduce new access control related product features (such as custom RBAC); leading effective software delivery on a new team; documenting and evangelizing access control best practices for all teams at Webflow.

Senior Backend Software Engineer (Collaboration)

Webflow, April 2021 - June 2024

Lead major product feature initiatives that enabled teams to collaborate within Webflow more effectively and increase adoption on the website experience platform: introduced workspaces, roles & permissions, service provider guests, and content editor specific use-cases.

Senior Backend Engineer

Simple Finance, September 2019 - March 2021

Fostered development and cross-team collaboration on backend microservices, with an emphasis on leadership, mentorship, and being a force-multiplier for the team. Architected and launched a solution with a 3rd-party integration for digital direct deposit, before taking a deep dive into Simple's infrastructure to build out a new self-service oriented infrastructure platform designed to reduce overhead of maintaining legacy home-grown infrastructure tooling and drive the Engineering organization towards more modern dev ops practices.

Backend Engineer

Simple Finance, April 2018 - August 2019

Developed and maintained backend microservices (Scala, Java, with AWS RDS PostgreSQL), contributing to company wide initiatives around one of Simple's key product features (protected accounts and savings tools). Lead architectural changes for the same products, and stewarded the adoption of Jira and agile based workflows.

Software Engineer (Backend)

Jive Software, June 2017 - March 2018

Focused on developing the Jive platform (Java, Spring, Struts 2) and related components of Jive's next-generation architecture, including microservices (built with Dropwizard, Guice, Hystrix, JUnit, and ReactJS) that leverage AWS offerings (S3, RDS, DynamoDB). Practiced Agile (Scrum) and continuous integration (Git, Stash, Jenkins) development methodologies.

Software Engineer (Tools)

Jive Software, May 2014 - June 2017

Focused on developing customizations to the Jive platform using the Jive plugin framework. Built a microservice to support plugin and add-on customizations using full Javascript stack that integrated with 3rd party applications such as Salesforce, JIRA, and PagerDuty. Practiced continuous integration development and was responsible for product management and project management for these tools.

Education

University of Portland Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

2008 - 2012

Publications

Extracting Episodic Memory Feature Relevance Without Domain Knowledge

BICA, December 2011